DDD-S-281K
February 2, 1978
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. DDD-S-281J
January 10, 1974

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

SHEET, BED, COTTON, AND POLYESTER-COTTON

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for cotton and polyester-cotton bed sheets.

1.2 Classification. The sheets shall be of the following types and sizes as specified (see 3.2, 3.4, and 6.2):

Type I - Cotton - Commercial designation No. 140 (muslin)
Type II - Cotton - Commercial designation No. 128 (muslin)
Type III - Cotton - Commercial designation No. 180 (percale)
Type IV - Polyester-Cotton (50/50)-Commercial designation No. 180 (percale)
Type V - Polyester-Cotton (65/35)-Commercial designation No. 180 (percale)
Type VI - Polyester-Cotton (50/50)-Commercial designation No. 128 (muslin)

Schedule of sizes

Size	Width		Length (cut or torn)	
	inches	cm	inches	cm
1	45	114	72	183
2	54	137	90	229
3	54	137	99	251
4	63 or 66	160 or 168	99	251
5	63 or 66	160 or 168	106	269
6	72	183	106	269
7	72	183	108	274
8	90	229	114	290
9	54	137	106	269
10	54	137	92	234

FSC 7210

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

V-T-276	-	Thread, Cotton.
UU-P-268	-	Paper, Kraft, Wrapping.
CCC-C-430	-	Cloth, Sheeting, Cotton, and Polyester and Cotton.
DDD-L-20	-	Label: for Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage (General Use).
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-45	-	Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, For Sealing and Securing.
PPP-T-60	-	Tape: Packaging, Waterproof.

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
FED-STD-751	-	Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC, 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers, at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Philadelphia, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Houston, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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Military Specifications:

MIL-T-43548	-	Thread, Polyester, Cotton-Covered.
MIL-T-43624	-	Thread, Polyester, Spun.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MS 16686	-	Medical Services Symbol.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act

(Copies may be obtained without charge from the Federal Trade Commission, Washington, DC 20580.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. (See 6.5)

3.1.1 Basic material.

3.1.1.1 Type I sheets. The basic material for type I sheets shall be cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 1, style A of CCC-C-430.

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3.1.1.2 Type II sheets. The basic material for type II sheets shall be cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 1, style B of CCC-C-430.

3.1.1.3 Type III sheets. The basic material for type III sheets shall be cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 1, style C of CCC-C-430.

3.1.1.4 Type IV sheets. The basic material for type IV sheets shall be polyester and cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 1, style E of CCC-C-430.

3.1.1.5 Type V sheets. The basic material for type V sheets shall be polyester and cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 1, style D of CCC-C-430.

3.1.1.6 Type VI sheets. The basic material for type VI sheets shall be polyester and cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 1, style F of CCC-C-430.

3.1.1.7 Color of sheets. The color for all types of sheets shall be bleached white or dyed, as specified (see 6.2).

3.1.2 Thread.

3.1.2.1 Types I, II, and III sheets. The thread for hemming the type I, II, and III sheets shall be cotton conforming to type IA2 or IA3 of V-T-276. When stitch type 301 is used, the thread shall be ticket No. 60, 3 ply. When stitch type 401 is used, the needle thread shall be ticket No. 60, 3 ply and the looper thread shall be ticket No. 70, 2 ply or ticket No. 80, 2 ply.

3.1.2.2 Types IV, V, and VI sheets. The thread for hemming the types IV, V, and VI sheets shall be cotton-covered polyester thread conforming to ticket No. 70, 2 ply of MIL-T-43548; or spun polyester thread conforming to class 1 or 2, ticket No. 70, 2 or 3 ply of MIL-T-43624.

3.1.2.3 Color of thread. Except for the top and bottom hems for types IV, V, and VI sheets (see 3.1.2.3.1), the color of the thread for all types of sheets shall be the same as specified for the cloth employed for the sheets (see 3.1.1.7).

3.1.2.3.1 Color of thread for types IV, V, and VI sheets. The color of the thread for the top and bottom hems of types IV, V, and VI sheets shall be shade Orange TL, C.A. 66076 (see 3.4.1 and 6.3).

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3.2 Dimensions. The dimensions of the sheets before hemming shall be as specified in 1.2. A minus tolerance of 1 inch (2.5 cm) and any plus tolerance in width or length will be permitted. The 45 inch (114 cm), the 54 to 66 (137 to 168 cm) and the 72 to 90 inch (183 to 229 cm) sheets shall not be biased more than 2, 3, and 4 inches (5, 8, or 10 cm), respectively.

3.3 Construction. Unless otherwise specified herein (see 3.4.2), all sheets shall have selvage edges on both sides.

3.4 Hems. All hems shall be straight and of uniform width. Stitches, seams, and stitchings shall conform to FED-STD-751. Hems shall be sewn so that no raw edges, run-offs, twists, pleats, puckers, or open seams result. Ends of all seams and stitchings when not caught in other seams or stitchings shall be backtacked or backstitched not less than 1/2 inch (13 mm). Thread breaks shall be secured by stitching back of the breaks not less than 1/2 inch (13 mm) at each break. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a length of not more than 1/2 inch (13 mm).

3.4.1 Top and bottom hems. All sheets shall have top and bottom hems. The hems shall be sewn using stitch type 301, seam type EFb-1 with 8 to 12 stitches per inch (3 to 5 stitches/cm). The turn-under shall be not less than 1/4 inch (6 mm). Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the hems shall finish 1 ± 1/4 inch (25 ± 6 mm) at each end. The stitching shall be placed 1/16 to 1/8 inch (2 to 3 mm) from the turned edge (see 3.1.2.3 and 3.1.2.3.1).

3.4.1.1 Special hem for type I, size 7 sheet. When specified (see 6.2), type I, size 7 sheets shall be finished with a top hem of 3 ± 1/4 inches (76 ± 6 mm) and a bottom hem of 1 ± 1/4 inches (25 ± 6 mm).

3.4.2 Alternate side hems. Sheets may contain, in addition to the top and bottom hem, a side hem 3/16 to 1/4 inch (5 to 6 mm) wide in lieu of one selvage. The side hem shall be sewn using stitch type 301 or 401, seam type EFb-1 with 8 to 10 stitches per inch (3 to 4 stitches/cm). The turn-under shall be 1/8 to 3/16 inch (3 to 5 mm). The stitching shall be placed 1/32 to 1/16 inch (1 to 2 mm) from the turned edge.

3.5 Marking.

3.5.1 Size marking, civil agencies. For civil agencies, each sheet shall be hem marked with the size of the sheet in characters approximately 1/8 inch (3 mm) in height. The marking shall conform to type III or IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. As an alternate, the marking may be done with a sewn in label. The marking shall show good fastness to accelerated laundering.

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3.5.2 Identification marking. When marking for identification is specified (see 6.2), the marking shall conform to type III or IV, class 4 of DDD-L-20. As an alternate, the marking may be done with a sewn in label. The size legend shall include the width and the cut or torn length of the sheet. The end item marking shall show good fastness to accelerated laundering. Unless otherwise specified the marking shall be centered on either hem, at one corner of the sheet, for sheets with top and bottom hems of the same width. For sheets with top and bottom hems of different widths, the marking shall be centered on the wider hem and at one corner of the sheet.

3.5.3 Marking for medical procurement. When specified (see 6.2), each sheet shall be marked on the top 3-inch (76 mm) hem with a caduceus of appropriate size, centered between the letters "U" and "S" (3/16 to 1/2 inch (5 to 13 mm) in height) in accordance with type I of MS-16686. Marking shall be placed in any corner of the sheet, except when identification marking is required, marking shall be placed in the same corner as the identification marking. The markings shall conform to type III or IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. The marking shall show good fastness to accelerated laundering.

3.5.4 Ownership marking.

3.5.4.1 Civil agencies. When specified (see 6.2), each sheet shall be marked with an ownership marking in letters 1 inch (25 mm) in height. Markings shall conform to type III or IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. The marking shall show good fastness to accelerated laundering. Unless otherwise specified, marking shall be centered and applied approximately 18 inches (457 mm) from one end of the sheet.

3.5.4.2 Military services. For military procurements, each sheet shall be marked with the legend "U.S." in block type, 1/2 inch (13 mm) in height. Markings shall conform to type III or IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. The marking shall show good fastness to accelerated laundering. Markings shall be placed on one hem in any corner of the sheet. When identification marking is required, the "U.S." marking shall be placed in the same corner as the identification marking. The use of a loop or sewn in label, in the same approximate location as the presently specified marking, shall be allowed as an alternate. This loop or sewn in label shall conform to type I, class 9 of DDD-L-20, and the legend "U.S." shall be in block type, 1/2 inch (13 mm) in height, and shall show good fastness to accelerated laundering.

3.6 Fiber identification. Each sheet shall be labeled for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

3.7 Workmanship. The finished sheets shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 Inspection of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, standards, and drawings unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 Examination of the end item.

4.2.2.1 Screening examination. The production of sheets shall be visually screened by the supplier and sorted into lots designated as first and second quality (see 6.4) in accordance with standard industrial practice.

4.2.2.2 Examination for acceptance of first quality lots. Lots designated by the supplier as first quality (see 4.2.2.1) shall be examined for acceptance by the Government. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated sheet. The inspection lot shall consist of all sheets presented for inspection at one time.

4.2.2.2.1 Visual examination. The lot of sheets shall be sampled in accordance with inspection level I and visually inspected. Any sheet which is found to contain either or both of the following shall be classified as a defective unit:

Any major defect listed in table I.
More than four minor defects listed in table I.

The acceptable quality level (AQL) for this examination shall be 4.0 percent defective.

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TABLE I. Classification of visual defects

Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Material (cloth)		
Hole, cut, tear, or smash	X	
Floats or skips:		
Multiple, 1/2 square inch (3.2 cm^2) or more in area	X	
Multiple, less than 1/2 square inch (3.2 cm^2) in area		X
Single, over 9 inches (229 mm) in length		X
Broken or missing yarns:		
Three or more, less than 9 inches (229 mm) apart regardless of length	X	
Two, less than 9 inches (229 mm) apart over 3 inches (76 mm) in length		X
Mitchback:		
Distorted, 2 square inches (12.9 cm^2) or more in area	X	
Distorted area less than 2 square inches (12.9 cm^2) and more than 1 square inch (6.5 cm^2)		X
Slub, slug, gout, jerked-in filling, or slough off:		
Over 1/8 inch (3 mm) in thickness	X	
1/16 to 1/8 inch (2 to 3 mm) in thickness		X
Spot, stain, or streak:		
Exceeding 1 inch (25 mm) in longest dimension	X	
More than 1/4 inch (6 mm) but not exceeding 1 inch (25 mm) in longest dimension		X
Accumulation of spots or stains 1/4 inch (6 mm) or less in longest dimension (five or more per sheet)		X
Heavy place		X
Light place or thin place:		
Three inches (76 mm) or less in longest dimension	X	
More than 3 inches (76 mm) in longest dimension	X	
Color not as specified		X
Temple mark or abrasion mark		
Selvages:		
Omitted (not as specified)	X	
Construction and workmanship:		
Not specified construction (unless otherwise indicated herein)	X	
Any mend	X	
Needle chew	X	
Not made of one piece of material	X	

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TABLE I. Classification of visual defects (cont'd)

Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Thread - Color not as required	X	
Seams and stitching		
Open seam unless otherwise specified:		
Up to and including 1/2 inch (13 mm)		X
Over 1/2 inch (13 mm)	X	
NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more continuous skipped stitches or runoffs occur.		
Seam type or stitch type other than specified	X	
Hems:		
Alternate side hem when applicable - hemmed other than specified		X
Turn-under not as specified		X
Any hem omitted	X	
Width of hem more or less than specified		X
Hem twisted, pleated, or puckered		X
Stitches per inch:		
Up to and including 2 stitches per inch (0.8 stitches/cm) less than minimum specified		X
More than 2 stitches per inch (0.8 stitches/cm) less than specified	X	
More than 2 stitches per inch (0.8 stitches/cm) in excess of maximum specified	X	
Up to and including 2 stitches per inch (0.8 stitches/cm) in excess of maximum specified		X
Stitching margin:		
Not as specified		X
Stitching ends (when not caught in other seams and stitching):		
Not backstitched or backtacked	X	
Backstitched or backtacked less than 1/2 inch (13 mm)		X
Thread ends not trimmed as specified		X
Thread breaks:		
Stitched back of break less than 1/2 inch (13 mm)		X
NOTE: Thread breaks not seamed back of the break shall be classified as open seams.		
Stitch tension:		
Loose tension, resulting in loose needle or bobbin thread; tight tension, resulting in tightness or puckering of material at stitch line		X
Raw edge:		
Up to and including 1/2 inch (13 mm)		X
Over 1/2 inch (13 mm)	X	

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TABLE I. Classification of visual defects (cont'd)

Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Marking (when specified) omitted, incomplete, illegible, incorrect, wrong color, or misplaced	X	
Labeling for fiber content not in accordance with Textile Fiber Products Identification Act	X	

4.2.2.2.2 Dimensional examination. The lot of sheets shall be sampled in accordance with inspection level S-3 and examined for compliance with dimensions specified below. Any dimension that is not within the tolerances specified shall be classified as a defect. The AQL for this examination shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Finished width - Less than specified (see 1.2 and 3.2)
Length (cut or torn) - Less than specified (see 1.2 and 3.2)
Biased (see 3.2) - More than 2 inches (5.1 cm) for 45 inch (114 cm) width
- More than 3 inches (7.6 cm) for 54-66 inch (137-168 cm) width
- More than 4 inches (10.2 cm) for 72-90 (183-229 cm) width

4.2.2.3 Examination for acceptance of second quality lots when applicable (see 6.4). Lots designated by the supplier as second quality (4.2.2.1) shall be examined for acceptance by the Government. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated sheet. The inspection lot shall consist of all sheets presented for inspection at one time.

4.2.2.3.1 Visual examination. The lot of sheets shall be sampled in accordance with inspection level I and visually inspected. If any two sheets in the sample are found to contain either or both of the following, the lot shall be rejected:

More than three of the major defects listed in table I
More than eight total defects (major and minor combined)

4.2.2.3.2 Dimensional examination. The lot of sheets shall be examined for conformance with dimensional requirements in accordance with the procedures of 4.2.2.2.2.

4.2.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be closed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per one hundred units.

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Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted: incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling. Open and non-continuous heat sealed seams and closure of polyethylene bag. Omission of vent hole in polyethylene bag. Incorrectly fabricated bag. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number of interior packages per container is more or less than required. Number of sheets per wrapped bundle, sheets per bag, or bag per bundle is more or less than required. 1/

1/ For this defect, one wrapped bundle, three bags, or one bagged bundle, as applicable, shall be examined from each shipping container in the sample.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Civil agencies. Twelve sheets of one type, size, and color only, each folded to approximately 14-1/2 inches by 28-1/2 inches (370 by 725 mm) shall be evenly stacked one on another and completely wrapped in 40 pound minimum basis weight (65 g/m^2) kraft paper conforming to type I, grade B of UU-P-268. The ends of the wrap shall be neatly folded and secured with gummed paper tape not less than 2 inches (51 mm) in width. Alternatively, two folded sheets, of one type, size, and color only, shall be evenly placed together and packaged in a snug-fitting clear polyethylene film bag of 0.0015 inch (0.04 mm) thickness (± 20 percent tolerance). The polyethylene bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight, continuous and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag. The final heat seal closure to the bag shall be made as close as possible to the open end. The bag may be fabricated from polyethylene film tubing or sheeting. A 1/4 inch (6 mm) maximum diameter hole shall be made at one corner of each polyethylene bag to allow the excess air to escape. Six polyethylene bags containing two sheets each shall be evenly stacked one on another and securely tied with 1/4 inch (6 mm) woven cotton tape.

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5.1.1.2 Military requirements. Each sheet shall be neatly folded to approximately 9 by 10-1/2 inches (230 by 265 mm). Each sheet shall then be inserted in a snug-fitting flat style clear polyethylene film bag of 0.00125 inch (0.03 mm) thickness (+ 25 percent tolerance). The polyethylene bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight, continuous, and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag. The final heat seal closure to the bag shall be made as close as possible to the open end. The bag may be fabricated from polyethylene film tubing or sheeting. A 1/4 inch (6 mm) maximum diameter hole shall be made at one corner of each polyethylene bag to allow the excess air to escape.

5.1.2 Level C. Sheets shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The package and the quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing.

5.2.1.1 Civil agencies. Seventy-two sheets of one type, size, and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to class domestic, variety SW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed and reinforced with flat strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.3. In addition, all seams, corners, and manufacturer's joint shall be sealed by the application of 3-inch (76 mm) maximum width cloth tape conforming to type IV, class 1 of PPP-T-60.

5.2.1.2 Military requirements. Thirty sheets of sizes 1 and 2; or twenty-four sheets of sizes 5, 6, 7, 8, and 9, of one type, size, and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant variety SW, grade W5c of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat 2 in length, 1 in width, and 15 in depth for sizes 1 and 2; or 2 in length, 1 in width, and 12 in depth for sizes 5, 6, 7, 8, and 9, within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 22 inches (560 mm) in length, 9-1/2 inches (240 mm) in width, and 12 inches (300 mm) in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.3.

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5.2.2 Level B packing.

5.2.2.1 Civil agencies. Thirty-six sheets of one type, size, and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF or SF, class domestic, variety SW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety SW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.3. In addition, all seams, corners, and manufacturer's joint shall be sealed by the application of 3-inch (76 mm) minimum width cloth tape conforming to type IV, class 1 of PPP-T-60.

5.2.2.2 Military requirements. Thirty sheets of sizes 1 and 2; or twenty-four sheets of sizes 5, 6, 7, 8, and 9, of one type, size and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be packed flat 2 in length, 1 in width, and 15 in depth for sizes 1 and 2; or 2 in length, 1 in width, and 12 in depth for sizes 5, 6, 7, 8, and 9, within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 22 inches (560 mm) in length, 9-1/2 inches (240 mm) in width, and 12 inches (300 mm) in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.3. Alternatively, each shipping container shall be closed with 3-inch (76 mm) minimum width tape conforming to type I or II, class 2 of PPP-T-45. The tape shall be applied over the lengthwise seam of the outer flaps and the edge seams, and shall extend over the corners and edges of the box onto the adjacent box panels a minimum of 2-inches (51 mm).

5.2.2.2.1 Weather-resistant containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.3.

5.2.3 Level C packing. Sheets, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

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5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies.

5.3.1.1 Interior packages. Interior packages shall be marked or labeled on one end as specified for polyethylene bagged packages in 5.3.2.1.

5.3.1.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.2.1 Polyethylene bagged packages. Polyethylene bagged packages shall have the required identification information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The sheets are primarily intended for use as bed sheets.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, size, and color required (see 1.2, and 3.1.1.7).
(c) When other than 1 inch (25 mm) hems are required (see 3.4.1 and 3.4.1.1).
(d) Whether identification marking is required (see 3.5.2).
(e) Whether marking for medical procurement is required (see 3.5.3).
(f) Whether ownership marking for civil agencies is required (see 3.5.4.1).
(g) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(h) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.2.1).
(i) Type marking required (see 5.3).

6.3 Hem identification marking (types IV, V and VI sheets). Colored thread in sewing the top and bottom hems (see 3.1.2.3.1) is for differentiating polyester/cotton sheets from cotton sheets for differences in laundering procedures

6.4 Quantities and distribution of accepted second quality sheets shall be in accordance with the terms of the contract.

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6.5 Recycled material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of the specification (see 3.1).

6.6 Metric equivalents. Metric equivalents, indicated in parentheses throughout this document, are based on practices, conversion factors, and symbols specified in ASTM E 380 Standard for Metric Practice, and are for information only. In each instance the value stated in US customary units shall be controlling.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MS, SH
DLA - CT, DM

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

DC GOV'T-DCG
VA-DMS
GSA-FSS
COM-NBS

Project No. 7210-0229

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 90 cents each.

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